

Ryann Penrod

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Portfolio: <https://ryannpx.github.io/portfolioSite/>

EDUCATION

Brigham Young University — Provo, UT
Bachelor of Science, Computer Science: Human
Computer Interactions Emphasis
Expected Graduation: April 2028

Relevant Coursework:
Data Structures & Algorithms
Software Design
Human-Computer Interaction
Web Development
Database Systems

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, TypeScript,
JavaScript, Python, C++,
HTML/CSS
Frameworks & Technologies:

Frameworks & Technologies: Angular, Node.js, REST APIs, Git, GitHub
Areas of Interest: Software Engineering, UI Development, UX Design,
Human-Computer Interaction, User Research
Languages: English (Native), Spanish (Professional Proficiency)

EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant

BYU Family History Technology Lab

Oct 2023 - Present

- Develop front-end and back-end features for Relative Finder, a genealogy platform used by thousands of users.
- Redesigned the application's user interface to improve usability, accessibility, and overall user experience.
- Conducted Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) studies, gathered user feedback, and iterated on designs to optimize user workflows.
- Built a customizable ancestor collage feature that allows users to create personalized visual displays of family history.
- Developed backend functionality integrating with the FamilySearch API to automate data refresh processes and improve application performance.
- Collaborate with software engineers, researchers, designers, and FamilySearch partners throughout the development lifecycle.
- Participate in feature planning, code reviews, testing, and deployment of production software.

For the Strength of Youth Conference Counselor

Summer 2026

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter day Saints

- Led and mentored youth groups during multi-day leadership conferences across the United States.
- Taught daily classes, facilitated group discussions, and provided individualized mentoring in English and Spanish.
- Collaborated with counselor teams to organize activities, resolve conflicts, and create meaningful experiences for participants.
- Demonstrated adaptability by working extended weeks in fast-paced, high-responsibility environments.

Full Time Missionary (Spanish Speaking)

The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter day Saints

Jul 2024 - Dec 2025

- Served as a Spanish-speaking missionary throughout the Las Vegas area.
- Held leadership positions including Sister Training Leader, Missionary Trainer, and Social Media Office Representative.
- Led, trained, and mentored missionaries while coordinating efforts across multiple companionships.
- Communicated daily in Spanish while teaching, planning, and serving diverse communities.

ADDITIONAL SKILLS

- Professional proficiency in Spanish
- Strong background in user-centered design and usability testing
- Experienced collaborating in Agile software development teams
- Excellent written and verbal communication skills

LEADERSHIP

Student Body Vice President

PROJECT HIGHLIGHTS

Relative Finder

- Redesigned key user interfaces using Human-Centered Design principles.
- Planned and implemented production-ready features in Angular and backend services.
- Conducted usability testing and translated research findings into product improvements.
- Integrated FamilySearch APIs to improve application functionality and reliability.
- Worked closely with engineers and researchers to deliver software used by thousands of users.